



Aphrodite saw Psyche looking for Eros and was horrified. She decided to set Psyche three tasks, hoping to keep the pair apart.

That evening, Aphrodite appeared to Psyche. “If you ever want to see your husband again, you must sort these seeds into different piles by morning,” she said, pointing to a mound of thousands of grains all mixed together. Then she vanished. The task was impossible for a human alone. Psyche wept. Saddened by Psyche’s situation, an ant offered to help her. The ant gathered all the other insects, and among them they were able to separate the seeds before Aphrodite returned.

*Aphrodite was amazed that Psyche had completed the task.*



“Hmph. Well, now you must fetch me a cutting of wool from the sheep belonging to the sun god, Helios,” Aphrodite demanded. These sheep were vicious beasts that could only be tamed by a god, but Psyche set out to the island where they lived. While she was at sea, she heard singing coming from the reeds along the shore. “*Look for wool that has snagged on thorny plants,*” they sang. In this way, Psyche managed to gather enough golden wool without having to confront the sheep.



Even more astounded, Aphrodite went to Psyche a final time and said, “Your last task is to bring me a drop of beauty from Persephone, queen of the underworld.”